

4 Mobile Platforms

concepts to take care of your data's security. If your device gets lost or stolen, Remote Wipe will wipe out all the data from the device as well as the memory card if it is inserted into the device so that it doesn't fall into wrong hands. You can access it through the Outlook Web Access (OWA) interface of your exchange server.

Another major threat to your data is loss of the memory card. It could be taken out of your device and read on a laptop thus making vital company information susceptible to theft. To protect against theft of information in such a way, Windows Mobile 6 brings built-in AES 128 bit encryption of the memory card, replacing third party file encryption applications. If you turn it on, the encryption application automatically encrypts any new information stored on the external memory card. The handling of the decryption of large files has been done well and the access time to information stored on the SD card has a low access time.

However, this application does not encrypt any data already stored on the memory card. So retrospective encryption will not take place. You might assume all their data is safe on a removable medium, but actually is unprotected. Another potential risk is that the rightful owner can be locked out of his own data in certain situations. The decryption keys associated with the memory cards cannot be exported but are lost after a hard reset. This means that if your device gets a (spontaneous) hard reset, you can't read your own memory card. Also, if your device stops working for some hardware problem (this includes dropping your phone in water), encryption implies that you lose access to your own data until the device is brought to working condition which may not happen in a lot of cases.

4.3.7 Support

Microsoft maintains an informative and helpful support site for Windows Mobile 6 users. As it stands now, you can search through a number of help and how-to articles to get you through the basics, such as setting up your device, then delve into more advanced capabilities.

4.3.8 What after Windows Mobile 6?

Windows Mobile 6.1

Windows Mobile 6.1 was announced April 1, 2008 but still does not feature in all Windows Mobile devices. Some vendors such as HTC did provide an update through a new firmware for their premier phones though and all the new Samsung Touch phones with Windows Mobile ship with this variant and a Touchwiz UI on top of it. It is a minor upgrade to the existing Windows Mobile 6 platform which brings with it various performance enhancements, threaded messaging capability and a redesigned Home screen featuring horizontal tiles that expand on clicking to display more information. There are other improvements such as full page zooming in IE , simpler email and Bluetooth setup, a "mobile" version of the Microsoft